



# Stakeholder Mapping

Week 6 • Day 1 • Stakeholder Alignment & Negotiation

TPM Academy



# Day 1 Objectives

- Build a **complete stakeholder list** — not an org-chart copy
- Place every stakeholder on a **Power × Interest grid**
- Assign **RACI** to the 5 most consequential decisions, with one A per decision
- Build a **watch list** — the high-power-low-interest stakeholders + their triggers
- Draft **SEP §1** — the input to engagement planning tomorrow



# Today's Shape

| Clock         | Block                       | Outcome                                    |
|---------------|-----------------------------|--------------------------------------------|
| 09:00 – 09:15 | Opening                     | Pin TCD §6 sign-off matrix on the wall     |
| 09:15 – 10:30 | Block 1 + Activity 1        | Build the stakeholder list (the 5 circles) |
| 10:45 – 12:00 | Block 2 + Activity 2        | Power × Interest mapping                   |
| 13:00 – 14:15 | Block 3 + Activity 3        | RACI for 5 decisions                       |
| 14:30 – 16:00 | Block 4 + Activity 4 + Wrap | Watch list + SEP §1 polish                 |

# Block 1 — Build the List

Org chart  $\neq$  stakeholder map



# The Five Circles

- **Customer-facing:** customer success, sales, support
- **Engineering-adjacent:** architecture, security, platform, infra, data, QA
- **Operating partners:** ops, IT, compliance, legal, finance
- **Decision-makers:** PM lead, eng director, GM, executive sponsor
- **Indirect interest:** other product teams whose work this touches

Most rookie lists are 5–7 names. A complete list is usually 10–18.



## What Good Looks Like

- Each stakeholder has a **name** (or named role) — not "the security team"
- Each has a **one-sentence concern** — what they care about
- Each has a **relationship to this feature** — consumer, owner, gate

**Watch for:** "TBD" entries. Force a name. The unowned stakeholder is the one who blindsides you.

# Activity 1 — Build the List

Triads • 35 minutes

- 5 min: copy from TCD §6
- 15 min: walk the 5 circles, augment
- 5 min: light cull
- 10 min: capture role + concern per stakeholder



5 + 15 + 5 + 10

# Block 2 — Power × Interest

Where each stakeholder lives





# The 2x2 Grid

## High Power, High Interest

**Manage closely** — key partners;  
frequent deep engagement

## Low Power, High Interest

**Keep informed** — engaged  
audience; you'll learn from them

## High Power, Low Interest

**Manage with authority** — the  
surprise-veto quadrant

## Low Power, Low Interest

**Monitor** — low effort; periodic  
check-ins

**The dangerous quadrant:** high-power, low-interest. They surprise you with a "no" at the worst time.



# Worked Example (FieldPulse)

High-Interest, High-Power: Eng Lead  
Customer Success Lead  
QA Lead

<p>High-Interest, Low-Power: Other dispatcher squads  
Internal users testing</p>  
<p>Low-Interest, High-Power: Architect  
Eng Director  
Security Lead  
CFO</p>

Low-Interest, Low-Power: Internal communications  
Ops floor

**Surprise:** Compliance is low-interest in the abstract but high-power in specific moments (audit deadlines). Position can shift.

## Activity 2 — Power × Interest

Triads • 40 minutes

- 5 min: sketch 2×2
- 15 min: place each stakeholder; argue when you disagree
- 10 min: name engagement style per quadrant
- 10 min: identify your 2 "surprises"



5 + 15 + 10 + 10

# Block 3 — RACI

One A per decision; if two, neither is



# RACI Refresher

| Letter | Role        | Definition                                          |
|--------|-------------|-----------------------------------------------------|
| R      | Responsible | Does the work. Many R's possible.                   |
| A      | Accountable | Owens the outcome. <b>Exactly one</b> per decision. |
| C      | Consulted   | Two-way; opinion sought.                            |
| I      | Informed    | One-way notification.                               |

**The discipline:** if two people are A, neither is. If no one is A, the decision rots.



# The Five Decisions

1. **Scope** — what's in vs out
2. **Architecture** — TCD §1 + key trade-offs
3. **SLO targets** — TCD §4
4. **Launch date** — when it ships
5. **OOS backlog ownership** — deferred items + owners

**The TPM rookie error:** "I'll be A for architecture." The architect is A. You're C.



## Worked RACI

| Decision     | R         | A            | C                       | I               |
|--------------|-----------|--------------|-------------------------|-----------------|
| Scope        | TPM       | PM Director  | Eng Lead, Architect, CS | Sales, Support  |
| Architecture | Architect | Eng Director | TPM, Security, Platform | All eng         |
| SLO targets  | Eng Lead  | TPM          | SREs, CS                | Eng Director    |
| Launch date  | TPM       | PM Director  | Eng Lead, CS, Marketing | All eng, Sales  |
| OOS backlog  | TPM       | TPM          | Eng Lead                | Backlog readers |

# Activity 3 — RACI for 5 Decisions

Triads • 40 minutes

- 20 min: draft matrix
- 5 min: "no two A's" check
- 10 min: "is the A actually empowered?" check
- 5 min: "anyone surprised by being I?"



20 + 5 + 10 + 5



# Block 4 — Watch List + Polish

The early-warning system



# The Watch List

For each **high-power-low-interest** stakeholder, identify the event that would move them to high-interest — and the trigger to escalate engagement.

| Stakeholder            | Trigger to escalate                     |
|------------------------|-----------------------------------------|
| CFO                    | Cost projection > \$X                   |
| General Counsel        | Any regulator email                     |
| Chief Customer Officer | Top-10 customer escalation              |
| Architect              | Architecture stance changes after Day 1 |

**The watch list is your early-warning system.** Distinguishes managers of stakeholders from reactors to them.

# Day 1 AI Prompt

```
Role: Senior PM coaching a junior TPM on stakeholder management.  
Context: <stakeholder list="" with="" quadrants="" and="" raci="">  
Task: Identify 3 likely blind spots:  
1. A stakeholder who probably has more power than the map shows  
2. A decision where the A is wrong or absent  
3. A high-power-low-interest stakeholder whose trigger isn't named  
Constraints:  
- Be specific to names and roles given  
- Do not invent stakeholders  
Format: 3 numbered findings, each with one-sentence rationale.</stakeholder>
```

# Activity 4 — Watch List + Polish

Triads • 45 minutes • Wrap

- 15 min: polish §1
- 20 min: build watch list (3–5 stakeholders + triggers)
- 5 min: cross-check vs TCD §6
- 5 min: AI prompt + provenance note



15 + 20 + 5 + 5 • 15-min wrap



# Day 1 Wrap

## What we built

- Comprehensive stakeholder list
- Power × Interest grid
- RACI for 5 decisions
- Watch list with triggers
- SEP §1 drafted

## What opens tomorrow

- **Managing engagement for outcomes**
- Per-stakeholder engagement plans
- Cadence + format + asks

**Bring to Day 2:** SEP §1. Tomorrow we plan the actual engagement.

# Questions & Reflection

Whose attention have you been spending too much on? Too little?